FIJI

Plastic Waste Profile



Plastic Waste Free Islands / IUCN



About this report

This Plastic Waste Profile is a technical summary of the report *Plastic Waste National Level Quantification and Sectoral Material Flow Analysis, Fiji National Report.*

Plastic Waste Free Islands

A four-year initiative led by IUCN to reduce plastic waste generation and leakage in island nations.

Prepared by

Asia Pacific Waste Consultants

Published by

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Year

2022

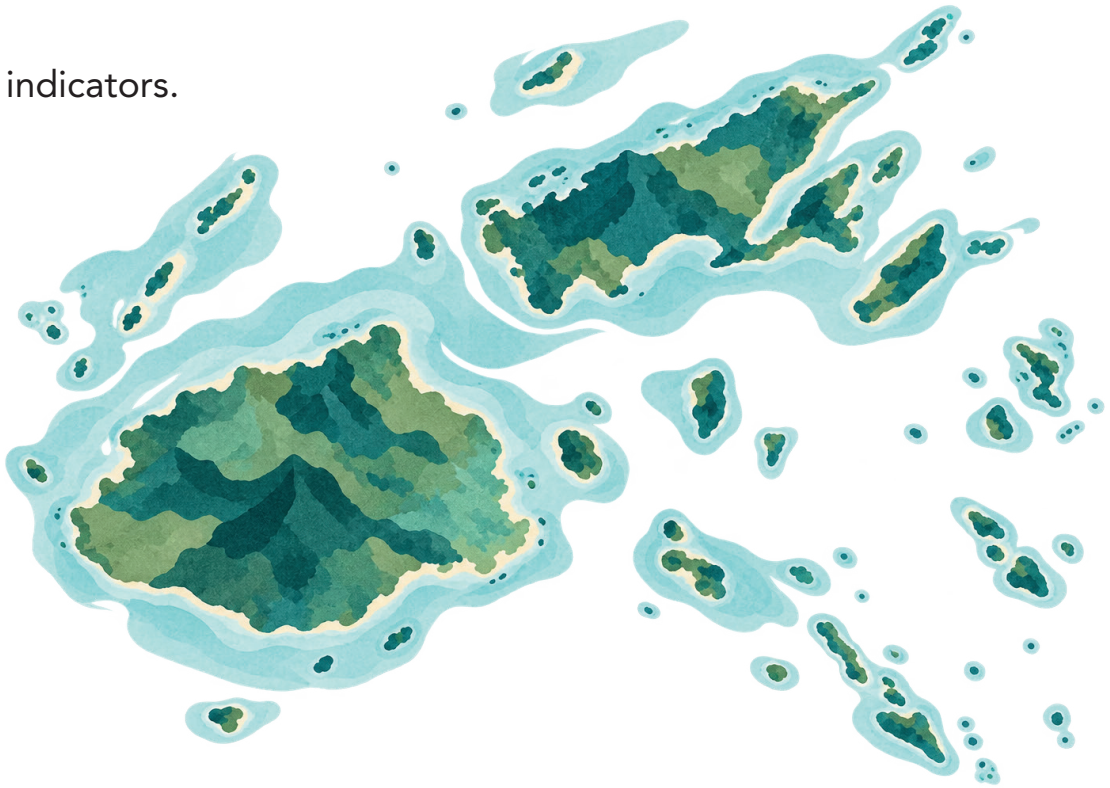
Fiji at a glance

Key geographic, demographic and economic indicators.

883,483
POPULATION (2018)

18,333 km²
LAND AREA

1.3M km²
EXCLUSIVE ECONOMIC ZONE



PEOPLE & CULTURE

56% urban / **44%** rural

Languages: English, iTaukei, Fiji Hindi

Ethnicity: 54% Indigenous Fijian, 40% Indo-Fijian

Education: 15 years of schooling

Census: 2017

GEOGRAPHY & GOVERNMENT

Capital: Suva

Climate: Tropical maritime

Terrain: Volcanic island archipelago

15 provinces / **4** divisions

Official name: Republic of Fiji

ECONOMY

GDP per capita: USD 6,220

GNI per capita: USD 5,860 (2019)

Currency: FJD

HDI: 0.724

MAIN EXPORTS

Water

Frozen fish

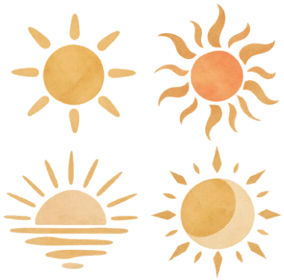
Gold

Processed fish

Fuel wood

The initiative in brief

Plastic Waste Free Islands was a four-year initiative led by IUCN to demonstrate effective, quantifiable solutions for reducing plastic waste generation and leakage in Small Island Developing States.



4 YEARS

2019–2022



3 STUDY SECTORS

HOUSEHOLD & COMMERCIAL

TOURISM

FISHERIES



6 ISLANDS

CARIBBEAN + OCEANIA

Working across regions and sectors, the initiative focused on practical, measurable solutions.



How Fiji's plastic flows were measured

7 POLYMER TYPES

8 FISHING VESSELS

18 TOURISM OPERATORS

250 HOUSEHOLDS

330 STAKEHOLDERS INTERVIEWED

31 COMMERCIAL PREMISES

180 LANDFILL TRUCKS VISUALLY AUDITED

The study looked at how plastic enters Fiji, how it is used, how it is disposed of, and where **it may leak into the environment.**

Researchers gathered information from households, businesses, tourism operators and fishing vessels, and combined it with landfill checks and interviews with local stakeholders.

Seven common types of plastic were tracked to build a clearer picture of how plastic moves through the country.



IMPORTS USE DISPOSAL LEAKAGE

How waste is managed in Fiji

Waste management in Fiji combines disposal sites, local funding and national measures to reduce plastic pollution.

Where waste goes

Fiji has **8 disposal sites**, but only **Naboro landfill** fully meets required standards.

Recycling is limited, and some rural and remote communities still lack regular waste collection.

How it's funded

Waste services are supported through **disposal fees, licences, environmental charges and fines**, as well as income from recycling and composting.

How waste is reduced

Fiji has introduced several measures to reduce single-use plastics, including a **plastic bag ban** and a **polystyrene ban.**

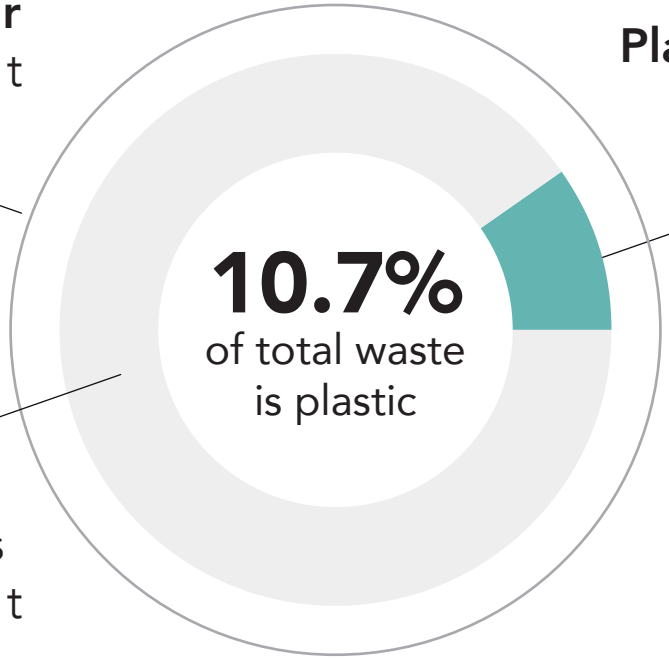


The big picture

Total waste per year
140,000 t



Plastic waste
15,000 t



Others
125,000 t

Plastic accounts for around **one in every ten tonnes of waste** generated in Fiji.

Most plastic waste comes from **commercial** and **household sources**, while tourism contributes a smaller share and fisheries only a very small amount.



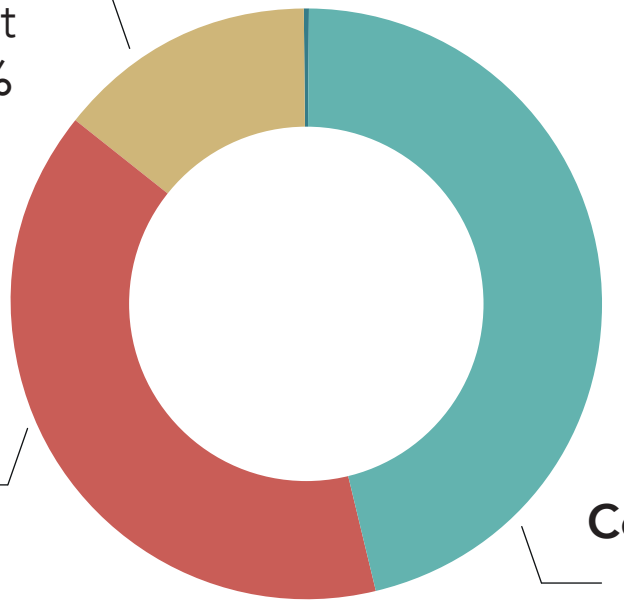
Tourism
2,117 t
14.2%



Fisheries
9.3 t
0.06%



Households
5,876 t
39.5%





Commercial
6,881 t
46.2%

Plastic waste by sector



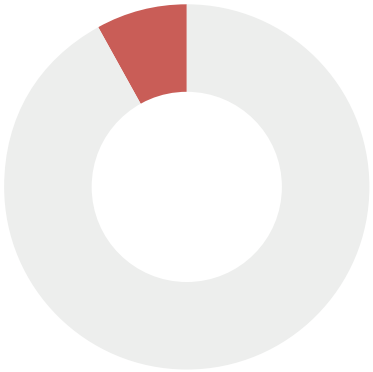
HOUSEHOLDS

Plastic represents less than one tenth of household waste.

75,361 t total waste / year

- **5,876 t** plastic waste

7.8% of household waste is plastic





COMMERCIAL

Plastic makes up a larger share of commercial waste than household waste.

47,943 t total waste / year

- **6,881 t** plastic waste

14.4% of commercial waste is plastic





TOURISM

Tourists generate much more plastic waste per person than local residents.

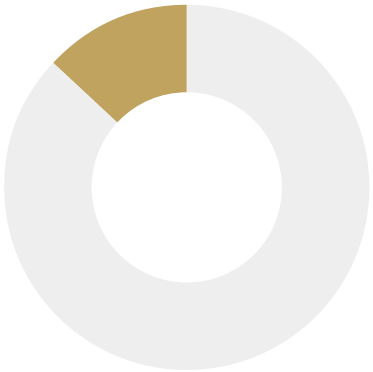
≈16,300 t estimated total waste/year

- **2,117 t** plastic waste

13% of tourism waste is plastic

199 g plastic waste / tourist / day

7× more plastic waste per person/day than a Fijian resident





FISHERIES

Plastic waste is much lower than in other sectors, but lost fishing gear remains a key source of marine plastic.

9.3 t consumer plastic waste / year

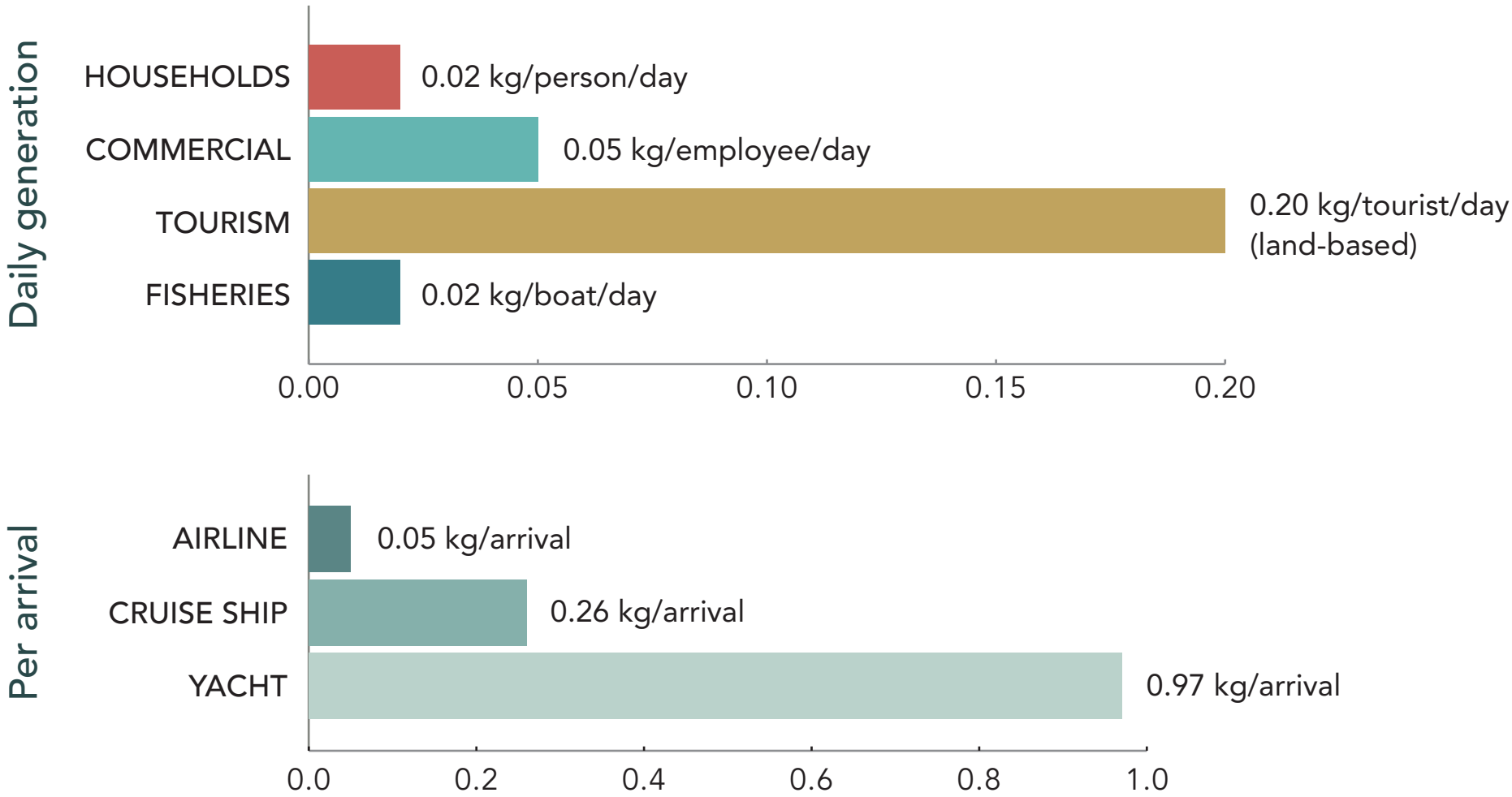
Fiji fishing fleet

93 international vessels

1,276 domestic / artisanal vessels

Waste intensity by activity

Measured per person, employee, tourist, arrival or boat, depending on the activity.



Plastic leakage from fisheries

Even though fisheries contribute little to Fiji's total plastic waste, lost gear and consumer plastics can leak directly into the marine environment.

CONSUMER PLASTICS

Consumer plastics used in the fisheries sector can also leak into the marine environment. **PET accounts for 60% of consumer plastic waste**, and water bottles are the most common item recorded.



2.9 t/year of consumer plastics leaked

FISHING GEAR

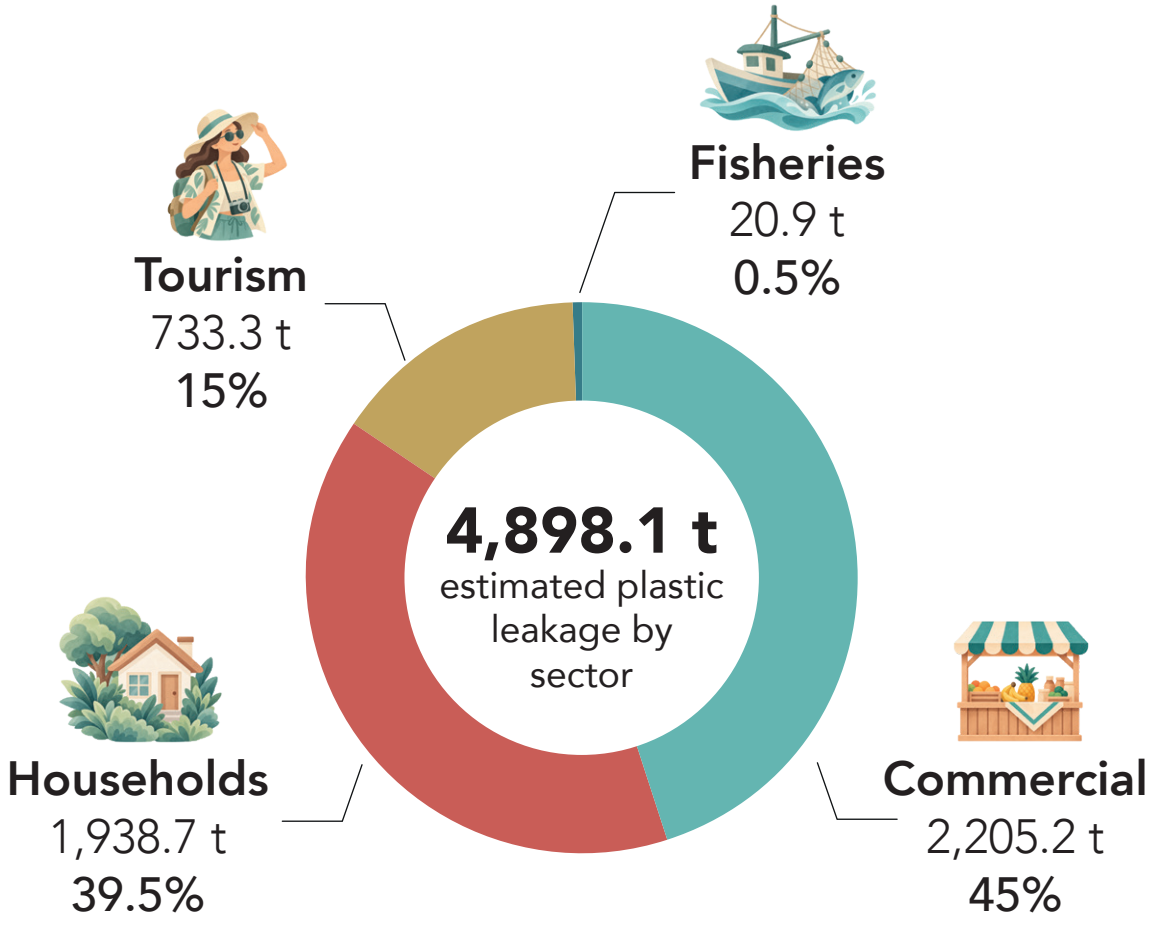
Lost or discarded fishing gear is a major source of marine plastic leakage. **Nylon fishing line** is the most common plastic component, accounting for **85% of fishing gear plastic.**



19.9 t/year estimated fishing gear leakage

Where plastic leakage comes from

Overall modelling estimated **4,877 t of imported plastic leaked** or held in long-term reservoirs away from landfill. That equals **24.7%** of all plastic imported into Fiji.



Commercial and **household** sources account for more than **84% of total plastic leakage**.

LEAKAGE RATE BY POLYMER

PVC — 32.6%
PP — 30.0%
PS — 28.4%
HDPE — 25.2%
Other — 24.2%
LDPE — 22.8%
PET — 20.7%

Leakage rates are estimates; overall 95% credible interval: 8.5–40%.



What this means

10.7%

OF FIJI'S TOTAL WASTE IS PLASTIC

Plastic represents around one in every ten tonnes of waste generated.

84%+

OF PLASTIC LEAKAGE COMES FROM COMMERCIAL AND HOUSEHOLD SOURCES

These two sectors account for most plastic leakage overall.

199 g/day

OF PLASTIC WASTE PER TOURIST

Tourists generate much more plastic waste per person than local residents.

19.9 t/year

ESTIMATED FISHING GEAR LEAKAGE

Although fisheries generate little plastic overall, lost gear can leak directly into the marine environment.

Reducing plastic leakage means addressing both everyday waste and the **specific activities that allow plastic to escape directly into Fiji's environment.**

ABOUT THE RESEARCH

Based on **IUCN's Plastic Waste Free Islands** programme, including the Fiji Country Overview and supporting technical research on plastic waste flows, disposal and leakage.

READ THE FULL RESEARCH →

This visual summary highlights selected findings and does not replace the full reports. Data has been simplified and reorganised for visual communication purposes; some figures are rounded and should be read alongside the original methodology, assumptions and limitations.

Visual summary & design by María Vera.
All illustrations in this document were created specifically for this project.

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